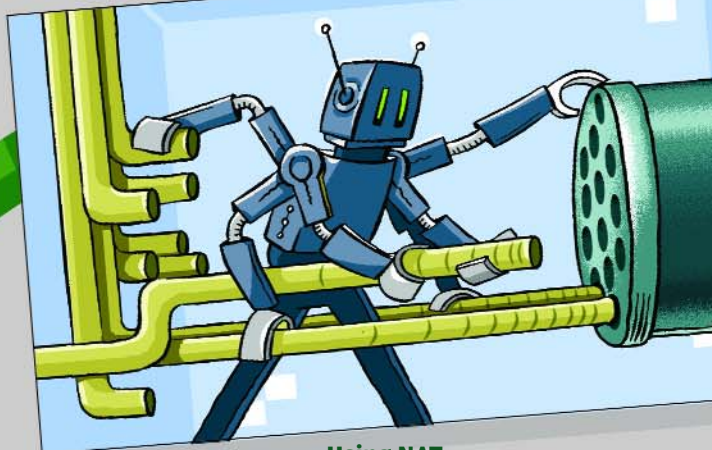


How Shared Internet Works

In a typical office environment, an Internet connection is shared over a network across several users. The two basic sharing systems are **NAT (Network Address Translation)** and **Proxy (Squid in our example)**. Here's how they work...

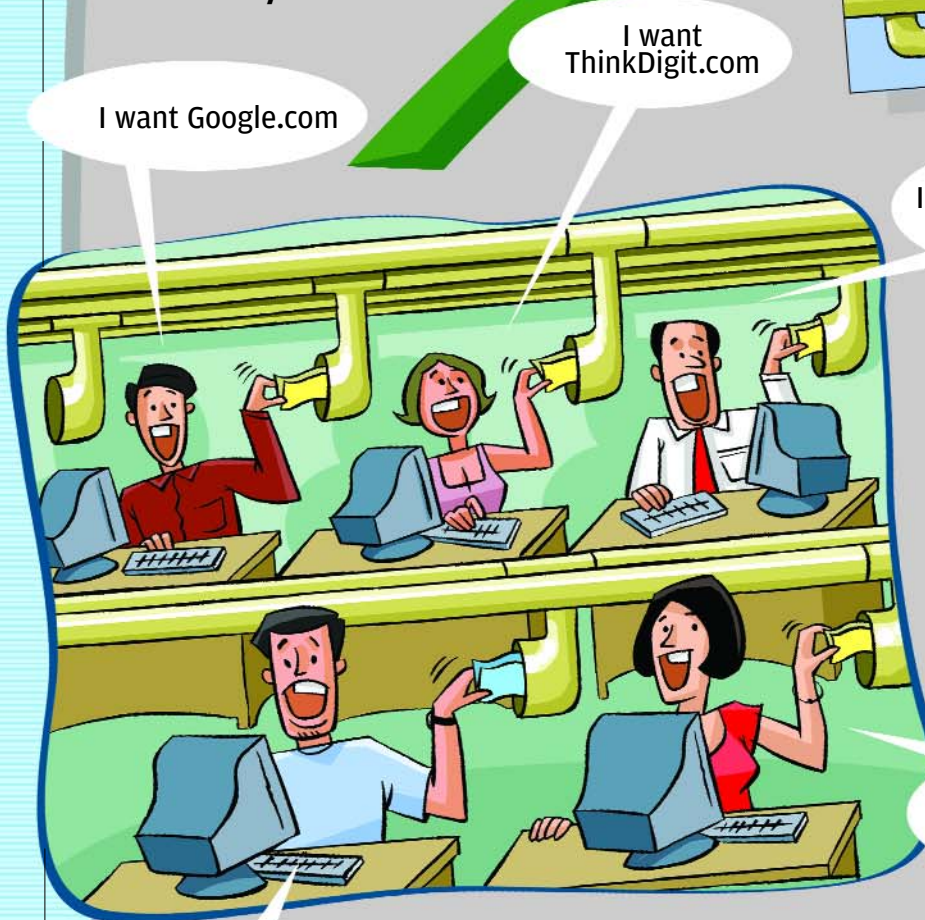


Using NAT

A NAT (Network Address Translation) server works like a robot. It shows no understanding, and doesn't care what it is you want. All it knows is that one Internet Protocol (your computer's) wants to connect to another (the IP of the server you want to connect to). A NAT server is a solution for all non-HTTP traffic, as all other protocols have no need for caching.

Varied Requirements

In a typical office, connectivity requirements differ from user to user. We can break up these requirements into HTTP requests and 'other' protocols, but every computer wants data, and it wants it now



I want Google.com

I want ThinkDigit.com

I want to connect to IRC

I want MSN Messenger to connect

I want streaming audio

Squid

Proxy servers, such as Squid, can take care of HTTP requests. Squid, for example, is intelligent. It reads what you want, then checks its cache for the requested item. In the example, Google.com is present in the cache, whereas ThinkDigit.com isn't

